

EMMANUEL BAHINDI

SOFTWARE ENGINEER • AI PRACTITIONER • SPEAKER ON AI & TECHNOLOGY IN AFRICA

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“I build software with AI every single day, and I teach a continent to do the same.”

Software engineer at the intersection of AI, media, and African innovation: I ship production web platforms with AI in the loop daily, designed the AI curriculum now training East Africa's journalism educators, and speak publicly on artificial intelligence, its future, and what it means for Africa.

SUMMARY

Software Engineer with 5+ years designing, building, and deploying web applications end to end: requirements, architecture, development, deployment, documentation, and user training. Currently Multimedia Web Developer at Media Challenge Initiative and Project Technical Lead of its AI Media Lab, where I architect AI-powered learning platforms and lead AI capacity-building across Uganda and Kenya. 30+ delivered projects for NGOs and businesses. Daily practitioner of AI-assisted engineering: LLM-integrated products, prompt engineering, and AI-accelerated development, documentation, and content pipelines.

CORE COMPETENCIES

AI-Native Engineering: daily production use of LLMs • prompt engineering • LLM API integration • AI-assisted code, testing & documentation • AI ethics & verification frameworks (co-developed the Ubuntu AI Ethics Code training programme)

Full-Stack Development: JavaScript, PHP, HTML5, CSS3 • React, Next.js 14, Laravel, Tailwind CSS, Bootstrap • MongoDB, MySQL, Sanity, Strapi • Git/GitHub, Jest, React Testing Library, Docker, Postman • system integration & database architecture • LAN/WAN administration

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Multimedia Web Developer & Technical Lead, AI Media Lab • Media Challenge Initiative

Aug 2023 – Present

4th Floor, Tirupati Mazima Mall, Kabalagala, Kampala, Uganda • +256 773 165 989

- Lead development and deployment of enterprise web applications with Next.js 14, React, and modern frameworks, owning the full lifecycle from requirements to deployment, documentation, and end-user training.
- Serve as Technical Lead on “Integrating AI Competences for Fighting Disinformation into Journalism Education in Eastern Africa” (with CAMECO, German-funded): architected and shipped a phone-first, low-data AI e-learning platform serving as the programme's official learning product (launched Aug 2026).
- Co-designed and lead-facilitated a 5-day AI Training of Trainers for **22 university journalism educators from Uganda and Kenya**, who now deliver the curriculum to **400 students** across both countries.
- Authored the 4-course, 18-video “AI for Journalists” curriculum (AI foundations, prompting, ethics, AI content creation), and serve as its on-camera instructor for the National Newsroom Contest 2026.
- Built and maintain MCI's digital estate: the [MCI website](#), [Media Challenge Awards](#), [MCI Catalyst](#), [Media Challenge Fellowship](#), [Love Facts Stickers](#), and [Solutions Now Africa](#); document all systems and train end users.

Founder & CEO • COTE TECH (U) LTD, Kampala

2024 – Present

- Founded and lead a digital solutions company delivering web platforms and AI-enabled products for organizations in Uganda, with AI-assisted engineering as standard practice across delivery.
- Delivered [INSPIRE AFRICA](#), a labour-mobility infrastructure website for a UK-registered client, end to end: design, build, deployment, and handover.

IT Officer (Intern) • Baylor Foundation Uganda, Kampala

Sep 2022 – Mar 2023

- Built business-process automation that improved operational efficiency by **30%**; designed internal web interfaces in React + Tailwind; provided organization-wide IT support, LAN/WAN administration, and technical documentation.

Full-Stack Software Developer (Freelance) • Kampala

2020 – 2022

- Delivered **30+ projects** for NGOs and businesses, including [TAPA](#), [TAMKEEN Academy](#), [Share An Opportunity Uganda](#), [Musawo Betty Care & Research Center](#), [Passionate Hearts Ministries](#), and [Maritime Shipping Company Ltd.](#)

PUBLIC SPEAKING & MEDIA (SELECTED)

- [“Starlink Is a Meaningful Disruptor”: Satellite Internet vs Africa's Telecom Giants](#) — Switch Africa (TikTok): technology analysis on connectivity and competition in East Africa.
- [Highlight Video for the AI Journalism | AI Media Lab ToT](#) — YouTube, Media Challenge Initiative: lead facilitator of the 5-day AI Training of Trainers, Kampala, Jul 2026.
- [AI vs Human Intelligence](#) — The Rest of Us podcast (TikTok): guest speaker on artificial intelligence and the future of human work.

Available for keynotes, panels, and trainings on: AI and the future of work in Africa • AI-driven disinformation and how societies fight it • practical AI adoption for organizations • building AI-era digital products for low-bandwidth markets.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

BSc. Software Engineering • Makerere University, Kampala

2019 – 2024

- Final-year project: Fuel Demand Forecasting System (using AI). Coursework: SDLC, database management, system integration, software testing.

Responsive Web Design • freeCodeCamp

2023